VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF FRI OCT 16 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

Results tomorrow, and a share for every child

SpaceX reports its third quarter after the close on Tuesday, its second report as a public company, and up to 1.3 billion locked-up shares become sellable two trading days later. "Next year, I will give one of my SpaceX shares to every kid in America. This will be the first of many," Elon Musk posted at 3:52 a.m. EDT Monday, a gift worth about $10.5 billion at Friday's close, CNBC calculated. Bandwagon-5 slipped a day to Tuesday because of recovery weather. New York City Council members called SpaceXAI's testimony on Grok safety evasive, and Ukraine's president blamed Washington for Starshield speed limits. SPCX fell 1.74% to $146.03 on Friday.

TOMORROW · Q3 EARNINGS

Third-quarter results on Tuesday

Tue Oct 20 · results after the close · audio-only webcast 4:30 p.m. EDT

SpaceX set the date on Friday; the webcast will also stream on X (SpaceX). Analysts expect earnings of $0.17 a share on $13.02 billion in revenue, according to Yahoo Finance (17 and 18 estimates, retrieved Monday). Second-quarter revenue was $7.8 billion, with a $541 million net loss, TeslaNorth noted. Under the prospectus, up to 1.3 billion more Class A shares, 28% of those under the 180-day lock-up, are released on the second full trading day after the results: Thursday, October 22.

I · LAUNCHES & STARSHIP

A weather day for Bandwagon-5

No SpaceX launches since Thursday night; Starship aims for a double catch in November.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 40 at Cape Canaveral with Crew-12 on Feb. 13, 2026. Bandwagon-5 is set to fly from the same pad on Tuesday.

PHOTO: NASA/CORY S. HUSTON · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Bandwagon-5

"Now targeting no earlier than Tuesday, October 20 for Falcon 9's launch of the Bandwagon-5 rideshare mission from Florida due to unfavorable recovery weather conditions," SpaceX posted at 3:27 a.m. EDT Monday. Teams had encapsulated 32 payloads on Saturday (SpaceX). The window opens at 6:30 a.m. EDT; booster B1085, on its 19th flight, is to land on the drone ship A Shortfall of Gravitas, Spaceflight Now lists.

Starship Flights 15 and 16

Flight 15 is targeting November 8, with the goal of catching both Booster 22 and Ship 42, but both still need static fires; Ship 42's engines were removed for an extra cryogenic test, NASASpaceflight reported on Sunday. Musk has said the flight should come before Thanksgiving. Flight 16, likely Booster 23 and Ship 43, is aimed at December and could be the first Starship launch from Launch Complex 39A in Florida.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Two Falcons on Tuesday, Starship in November

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT).

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Tue Oct 20, 6:30 a.m.	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 mid-inclination rideshare, 32 payloads; booster B1085, 19th flight	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Confirmed	SpaceX; Spaceflight Now
Tue Oct 20, 6:14 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1063, 36th flight	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2; Spaceflight Now
Sat Oct 24, 1:29 a.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; booster and ship catches planned	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)
NET Nov 30	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
December	Starship	Flight 16, likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) month or an unofficial target. Date changes since Friday's issue: Bandwagon-5 moved from Monday to Tuesday, October 20, "due to unfavorable recovery weather conditions" (SpaceX); Starship Flight 16 is now listed for December rather than December 10. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

III · STARLINK

Kyiv and Washington spar over Starshield limits

Zelenskyy says the U.S. is behind the speed cap; the Treasury secretary told him to "be very careful."

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on NBC's "Meet the Press" on Sunday that he believed the U.S. government was responsible for the slowdown and that Starshield-linked vehicles and drones are still restricted in speed, CNBC reported. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent answered that President Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio "have categorically said that no one under the Trump administration did that," and that "President Zelenskyy should be very careful about making statements like this that aren't true." Musk wrote last week that "any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS."

QUICK HIT

Southwest. The airline has 47 aircraft connected to Starlink and expects its whole fleet equipped by fall 2027, its chief customer officer told AirlineGeeks. "Southwest Airlines going all-in with @Starlink!" Musk posted.

IV · SPACEXAI & SHAREHOLDERS

"Simply unacceptable," the Council speaker says

A subpoenaed SpaceXAI manager testified on Grok safety; Musk answered Anthropic with a share giveaway.

Before the City Council

Gabriela Castillo Madrid, SpaceXAI's senior manager of global government affairs, told the Committee on Technology by video on Friday that the company has "strict controls," CNBC reported. Speaker Julie Menin said she had made a sexualized image of herself with Grok that morning: "how is it that within a second, I could find a sexualized image of myself using Grok?" Castillo Madrid said the safety team would look into it. "Their testimony was simply unacceptable," Menin said afterward (NYC Council). Former employee Devin Kim testified that only three of the company's 200 technical employees worked on AI safety training; Castillo Madrid said under oath she was not aware of his firing.

QUICK HIT

Compute. Quoting a post titled "What it's like trying to rent AI/SI compute," Musk wrote that it "describes the conversation SpaceX has had when we have tried to rent inference compute from AWS, GCP or anyone at, so that we can shift load off our training clusters!!"

One share per child

Anthropic said Sunday it will commit 5% of its shares to a new public benefit fund, subject to stockholder approval

(Anthropic). "I recommend giving the shares directly to the public," Musk replied, then "This is what I will be doing." He did not say how a gift to the roughly 72 million U.S. children would work; he owns about 4.8 billion SpaceX shares, CNBC noted.

V · FILINGS: SEC, FAA & FCC

No new filings before the results

No new SEC filings or FAA Federal Register notices since Friday's issue; the Starbase review remains open.

FAA

Notice of intent · Oct 14 — The FAA will prepare a Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement (PEIS) on SpaceX's proposal to increase Starship-Super Heavy operations at Starbase (docket FAA-2026-12808). Phase 1 would allow 100 launches a year at any hour; Phase 2 up to 456, and even Phase 1 is not expected for at least a year, NASASpaceflight noted. Comments are due November 30. Federal Register

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Friday and 8:25 a.m. EDT Monday. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities; 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — Exercised options for 342,170 shares on September 22 and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72; 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FCC

Oct 8 · 800 MHz purchase — SpaceX's purchase of Grain's nationwide 800 MHz licenses is subject to FCC approval. Grain

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Nov 4 · Surety bond — Due under the October 6 order granting 15,000 Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in part. Exterra

Takeaways

1. SpaceX reports Q3 after Tuesday's close; the webcast is at 4:30 p.m. EDT.
2. Up to 1.3 billion locked-up shares can be sold from Thursday, October 22.
3. Musk pledged one of his SpaceX shares to every U.S. child next year.
4. Bandwagon-5 slipped to Tuesday for recovery weather.
5. NYC Council leaders called SpaceXAI's Grok testimony "unacceptable."

SOURCES

Posts by @elonmusk and @SpaceX on X; SpaceX, Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2, NASASpaceflight, FAA, Federal Register, NYC Council, Anthropic; CNBC, TeslaNorth, AirlineGeeks, Investopedia, Grain Management, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photo: NASA (public domain).

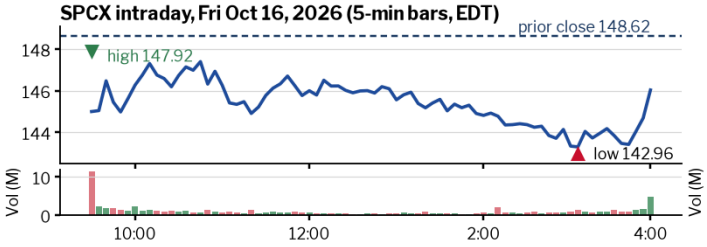
The SpaceX Dispatch is an independent weekday digest of public news, X posts, regulatory filings and market data about Space Exploration Technologies Corp., and is not affiliated with the company. Quotes are verbatim; emoji in quoted posts are omitted for print. Market data are delayed and may be revised. Not investment advice.

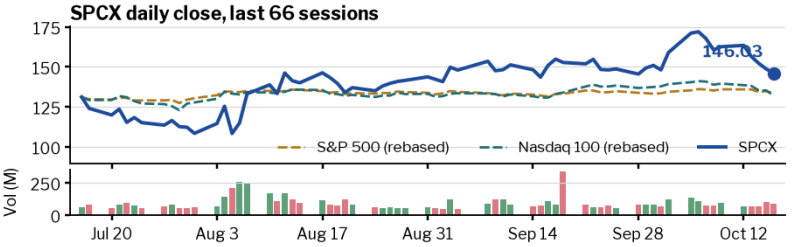
Down 1.7% in a tech sell-off

SPCX peaked at the open and closed down 1.74% as the Nasdaq 100 fell 2.50% and AI-tied stocks slid, Investopedia reported.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$146.03	−$2.59	$147.80	$147.92	$142.95
Fri Oct 16, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*−1.74% vs $148.62*	*regular session*	*9:30 a.m. EDT bar*	*3:05 p.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
88.19M	$105–$226	$1.92T	−10.2% / −5.7%	+8.2%
−5.4% vs 30-session avg 93.23M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $1.98T with Cursor shares*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; −9.27% vs first close*

SINCE IPO, OCT 16 — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $146.03 | high $225.64 · Jun 16; 50-day avg $148.15





As of close Oct 16, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 16 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−1.74%**	**−10.17%**	**−5.67%**	**−9.27%**
S&P 500	−1.09%	−1.95%	+0.28%	+3.07%
Nasdaq 100	−2.50%	−5.49%	−0.88%	−1.51%
RKLB	−7.98%	−25.47%	−25.04%	−50.35%
ASTS	−8.55%	−20.22%	−35.16%	−50.66%
IRDM	−2.73%	−7.82%	−7.83%	−7.52%

OPTIONS (CBOE, MON OCT 19, 8:17 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 19	63,011	78,270	1.24	40.3%	$157.50 / $140
Oct 21	30,899	30,798	1.00	83.6%	$155 / $135
Oct 23	107,223	129,769	1.21	78.7%	$165 / $140
All expiries	**2,063,093**	**2,223,536**	**1.08**		**30-day IV index 58.3**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 19

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (31 analysts)	$222.71 (+52.5%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.65%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 16 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $2.05)	71.4
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	83.5
Beta	—
50-day average	$148.15 (−1.4%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (17 analysts)	$0.17
Q3 revenue est. (18)	$13.02B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 16	Evercore ISI	Outperform	$230 to $275
Oct 9	Barclays	Overweight (initiated)	$254
Oct 9	TD Cowen	Buy	$200
Oct 8	Erste Group	Hold (initiated)	—
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Tue Oct 20	**Q3 results after close; webcast 4:30 p.m. EDT**
Wed Oct 21	Tesla Q3 results; webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT
Thu Oct 22	**Lock-up release: up to 1.3B more shares**
Sat Oct 24	Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 16). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Mon Oct 19, 8:24 a.m. EDT; Erste Group via TheFly. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Friday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $146 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $1.98T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4); the 1.3B release falls on the second full trading day after Q3 results. FCC dates: Exterra.